

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

The musical score is written for a single voice in 4/4 time, using a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is simple and repetitive, with a 4-measure phrase that is repeated throughout the song. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some lines numbered 1 through 4 to indicate different verses. The first line of the score is: 1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart. The second line is: 2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing... The third line is: 3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly... The fourth line is: 4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus... The fifth line is: Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart. The sixth line is: In my heart, in my heart, The seventh line is: Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart. The score ends with a double bar line.

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...
Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.
In my heart, in my heart,
Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.